

FOUR-COURSE SYSTEM

COURSE 3 - DATA ENGINEERING 2026

C3-115 DP-700 Alignment & Readiness

Optional Microsoft Fabric Data Engineer certification overlay - blueprint checked 11 Sep 2026

Status	OPTIONAL CERTIFICATION OVERLAY
Course boundary	C3-104 = C3-09 phase Gate only; C3-113 = separate course-wide graduation Gate
Release boundary	Course 3 is NOT FINAL until Mentor/PWA + whole-course release regression are complete.

Permanent engineering behavior controls the course. Vendor UI/version notes are refreshable references, and external links are support-only; the course artifacts remain sufficient without them.

1. Current official blueprint snapshot

Microsoft Learn currently lists DP-700 skills measured as of **21 July 2026**. The candidate profile expects data-loading patterns, data architectures and orchestration, plus SQL, PySpark and KQL.

Implement and manage an analytics solution	30-35%
Ingest and transform data	30-35%
Monitor and optimize an analytics solution	30-35%

2. Course 3 mapping

Implement/manage	C3-07 Fabric workspaces, Lakehouse/Warehouse/OneLake, lifecycle/security; C3-08 release/security/DataOps.
Ingest/transform	C3-01 ingestion; C3-02 transformation; C3-05 Spark; C3-06 streaming; C3-07 Fabric pipelines/PySpark/KQL foundations.
Monitor/optimize	C3-05 performance; C3-07 monitoring/capacity; C3-08 SLOs/incidents/security; C3-09 operational capstone.

3. Readiness before paying/scheduling

- Real hands-on Fabric evidence exists for Lakehouse/pipeline/notebook and relevant serving/warehouse work.
- You can use SQL and PySpark independently and work through foundational KQL tasks.
- You can explain security, monitoring and optimization - not just ingestion steps.
- You complete the current official Microsoft practice assessment/current prep near exam time.
- You re-open the official study guide immediately before scheduling because objectives can change independently of Course 3.

4. Certification boundary

DP-700 is optional and excluded from the 140-lesson mastery denominator. Passing the certification does not replace C3-113; deferring or failing it does not invalidate a valid Course 3 graduation decision.

5. Official sources

[DP-700 study guide](#)

[Microsoft Certified: Fabric Data Engineer Associate](#)

[Official DP-700 training course](#)

[Fabric Data Engineering documentation](#)